

Child Protection Staff Code of Conduct

WHAT YOU MUST DO:

All staff at Silverleaf Academy must adhere to the highest standards of conduct to ensure a safe and positive environment for pupils. Good practices include:

1. ***Equal and Respectful Treatment:*** Treating all children equally and with respect and dignity.
2. ***Child Welfare Priority:*** Always prioritize the welfare of each child.
3. ***Constructive Feedback:*** Providing enthusiastic and constructive feedback rather than negative criticism.
4. ***Use of Mandated Behavior Management Techniques:*** Using exclusively the behavior management techniques mandated by Silverleaf.
5. ***Building Trusting Relationships:*** Building balanced relationships based on mutual trust that empower children in decision-making processes.
6. ***Exemplary Role Modeling:*** Conducting oneself as an excellent role model, refraining from smoking or drinking in the company of or while responsible for children.
7. ***Maintaining Appropriate Distance:*** Maintaining a safe and appropriate distance with children by being aware of limits in physical contact, especially in situations where it is unavoidable.
8. ***Limited Use of Physical Force:*** Using physical force only where necessary as reasonable restraint, with minimum force for the shortest time.
9. ***Remaining Calm in Incidents:*** Remaining calm, seeking attention and support from other staff in incidents, and recording incidents in writing immediately afterwards.
10. ***Emergency First Aid:*** Administering emergency first aid and/or other medical treatment, documenting and reporting to a senior staff member who will inform parents or caregivers.
11. ***Comforting Distressed Children:*** Providing comfort to distressed children with discretion to ensure appropriateness.
12. ***Working in Open Environments:*** Always working in an open environment, avoiding private or unobserved situations and encouraging open communications with no secrets.
13. ***Confidential Interviews and Meetings:*** Conduct confidential interviews or one-to-one meetings in a room with an open door or visual access. If not possible, ensure another adult is nearby.
14. ***Transporting Children:*** Securing parental consent if transporting a child in your car.
15. ***Media Records Collection:*** Only collecting media records of children in line with procedures.
16. ***Questioning Unknown Adults:*** Questioning any adult at Silverleaf premises who is not in uniform, or badged, and escorted.

WHAT YOU MUST NOT DO:

No adult should engage in the following prohibited activities:

1. ***Physical Assault or Abuse:*** Hitting or otherwise physically assaulting or abusing children.
2. ***Inappropriate Relationships:*** Developing physical/sexual relationships with children.
3. ***Exploitative or Abusive Relationships:*** Developing any form of relationship with children that could be deemed exploitative or abusive.
4. ***Placing Children at Risk:*** Placing a child at risk of abuse or exploitation.
5. ***Inappropriate Language and Provocative Behavior:*** Using language, making suggestions, or offering advice that is inappropriate, offensive, or abusive. Behaving physically in a manner that is inappropriate or sexually provocative to children.
6. ***Unnecessary Involvement in Personal Care:*** Involving oneself in toileting and feeding children beyond what is strictly necessary and appropriate given the child's age and development.
7. ***Illegal, Abusive, or Unsafe Conduct:*** Condoning or participating in conduct that is illegal, abusive, or unsafe for children.
8. ***Emotional Abuse:*** Acting in ways intended to shame, humiliate, or degrade children, or perpetrate any form of emotional abuse.
9. ***Discrimination:*** Discriminating against, showing differential treatment, or favouring particular children to the exclusion of others.
10. ***Soliciting Support through Children:*** Inappropriately using children to solicit support, financial or otherwise.
11. ***Failure to Act:*** Being aware that a child is at risk of any of the above and not taking any action.
12. The following behaviours, often acceptable for parents or guardians in a domestic context, are forbidden for those working with children:
13. ***Unnecessary Alone Time with a Child:*** Spending unnecessary time alone with a child.
14. ***Inappropriate Physical Contact:*** Having physical contact with a child beyond what is essential for the child's safety or well-being or to demonstrate a particular technique.
15. ***Taking a Child Home:*** Taking a child home.
16. ***Assigning Domestic Tasks to Children:*** Making the child run errands, do domestic tasks, or work not connected with their learning.
17. ***Inappropriate Sleeping Arrangements:*** Sleeping in the same room or bed as a child.
18. ***Smoking or Drinking in the Company of Children:*** Smoking or drinking in the company of or while responsible for children.

Failure to act following this code of conduct is grounds for dismissal and or termination of the relationship with Silverleaf.

Name:

Role:

Signature:

Date: